Psychometric Paper Guidelines

Goal: Write a 5 – 7 page APA style paper which explains your questionnaire, including what construct it is supposed to measure and why measuring this construct is important. This paper will need to include at least 5 peer reviewed sources (i.e., not Wikipedia). These will primarily be for the introduction, but feel free to include more than five if you wish. Note that you will also need to include a title page and references page, neither of which count towards the page limit.

Some basic reminders:

- Double space your paper! (If you give me 7 single spaced pages of content, I probably won't read it….)

- Use a normal font (no wing-dings) – Times New Roman or Calibri are recommended. Use 11 pt or 12 pt font. Anything smaller is font for ants, and anything larger is going to result in me taking off points.

Your paper should at minimum include the following sections, which are detailed below.

Components of the research paper

1) Cover page (APA FORMAT) – You do **NOT** need to include an abstract for this paper.

2) Introduction/Literature Review: Give me the background on your project. Your first paragraph should introduce your topic. Next, provide a few paragraphs exploring previous research. What studies have already been conducted? Are there any inconsistencies in previous work (i.e., do some studies contradict each other?) You'll need to include 5 references in this section.

Your introduction should at minimum be about two and half pages long. *****Your last paragraph in this section should tie your scale/instrument to previous research. How does your scale improve upon previous work? How many facets is your construct? Is this different from how other researchers have investigated this topic?*

3) Method: Your method section will detail how you built and tested your scale

- **3A) Participants:** Who is your sample? (Where did you recruit them from? How many participants did you recruit? Did you exclude any?)

- **3B) Materials:** This is where you will describe your instrument. How many items total? How many items measure each facet?
    - **Be sure to provide specific examples!**

- **3C) Procedure:** Give me a step-by-step description of how participants took your questionnaire. You should write in a way that somebody else could easily follow along and reproduce your work.

At minimum, your method section (with all 3 sub sections) should be at least a page.

4) Results: What did you find? Did your findings support your hypothesized structure (i.e., if you thought that depression was made of 3 constructs, did your analyses support that?) You will need to report the following: Descriptive statistics, validity and reliability measurements, and factor analysis. You are welcome to include figures and tables but note that these do not contribute to the word count. Your results section should be at least one page.

5) General Discussion: Now that you've given me the results, what do they mean? Interpret your findings! Explain the general patterns and how they relate to your hypothesis. This section should be about a page.

6)Conclusion: Write at least one paragraph which summarizes your main points. You should also include a take-home message about why your study is important.

7) References: Make sure to include an APA style reference sheet. All references must come from peer reviewed journal articles! If you aren't sure if a reference is suitable for you to use, ask me.

Remember, the cover and reference pages **DO NOT** count towards the page limit!